

Mini Evaluation Report on Homify

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CHAPTER – 1: INTRODUCTION

This report presents the evaluation of the Homify mobile application prototype, designed to enhance the User Experience (UX) of high-value online home and furnishing purchases. Homify addresses limitations in traditional e-commerce by introducing advanced features such as Augmented Reality (AR) visualization, collaborative group shopping, and seamless platform integration ([Gallino & Moreno, 2014](#)).

The necessity for this solution is driven by the reality that consumers increasingly prefer online purchasing, thereby avoiding the inconvenience of product transport and in-store logistics. However, high-consideration items like furniture carry significant purchase risk, as customers struggle to visualize product fit and lack the sensory feedback of a physical store ([Lu & Smith, 2008](#)).

Homify specifically targets these pain points by offering a highly aesthetic and frictionless end-to-end shopping journey. The visual design adheres to the Aesthetics and Minimalism principle ([Pereyra, 2023](#)), reducing cognitive load ([Miller, 1956](#)) and instilling visual trust from the first interaction. This commitment to efficiency ensures that even the busiest user can seamlessly progress from product discovery through secure payment and coordinated delivery.

To rigorously evaluate the effectiveness of the Homify prototype, a small-scale user study was conducted using task-based usability testing, a post-use survey and qualitative interviews. This evaluation was guided by Norman's Interaction Design principles which focus on visibility, feedback, consistency, constraints, mapping and affordance to assess how easily users can understand and interact with the system ([Norman, 2013](#)). It also drew on Jordan's Four Pleasures Framework that considers physio pleasure, socio pleasure, psycho pleasure and ideo pleasure to explore the emotional and experiential quality of the interaction ([Jordan, 2002](#)). Together, these perspectives enabled a comprehensive understanding of how well the design supports both practical usability and user satisfaction.

1.1 Purpose of the Document

The purpose of this document is to report findings from the user evaluation of the Homify prototype. The evaluation examines:

1. How effectively the design supports usability, according to established interaction principles
2. How the interface influences user emotions, confidence, and perceptions while shopping home essentials
3. What aspects of the user experience require refinement in future design iterations

The results will guide improvement recommendations to enhance both functional and emotional quality of the product experience.

CHAPTER – 2: SYSTEM EVALUATION

2.1. User Evaluation Study Methods and Rationale

To evaluate Homify in realistic usage conditions aligned with the PACT framework, a blended study approach was used comprising task-based usability testing, post-test surveys and short interviews. Usability testing helped reveal practical interaction strengths and breakdowns as participants completed everyday shopping tasks using the prototype. Surveys then provided structured ratings on ease of use, confidence and interface clarity, while the interviews enabled participants to express their emotions, expectations and personal reactions to specific features.

This combination of direct observation and reflective feedback ensured a more holistic assessment of the system at an early stage of development, capturing both functional performance and the experiential quality of interaction ([Kefalidou and Sharples, 2016](#)). To guide interpretation, Norman's interaction design principles supported the usability analysis by illuminating where visibility, feedback, mapping, consistency, affordance and constraints succeeded or needed strengthening. Jordan's Four Pleasures framework further helped explain how the design influenced sensory comfort, cognitive engagement, social collaboration and alignment with user values, providing a broader view of user experience ([Norman, 2013](#); [Jordan, 2002](#)).

2.2 Participants

To ensure diverse perspectives and realistic usage scenarios, the study included 12 participants from different age groups, living arrangements, and digital shopping behaviours. Since Homify is designed for individuals furnishing their homes, particularly through online shopping, I targeted users with varying familiarity with e-commerce and mobile apps.

The participant group was distributed as follows:

- **6 young adults (18-27 years)**
University students or early-career professionals who frequently use mobile apps for shopping, payments, and home setup due to recent moves or limited time.
- **4 mid-career professionals (28-35 years)**
Individuals living independently or with flatmates, with moderate experience purchasing furniture or home goods online.
- **2 senior professionals (35-50 years)**
Users with established living spaces and more infrequent furniture buying behaviour.

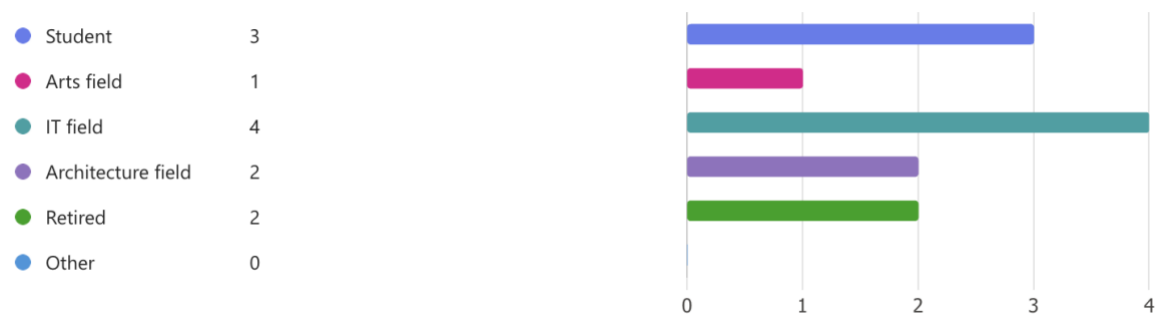


Figure 1: Participants' professions

All participants regularly use smartphones and at least one e-commerce/mobile payment application. None had prior exposure to the Homify prototype which ensures unbiased first-use feedback.

To protect personal identity and comply with ethical research guidelines, each participant was assigned an anonymised code (e.g., P1, P2, P3 etc.,).

2.3 Materials

The materials used in this system evaluation included:

- An interactive prototype of 10-screen medium-fidelity Homify app, created in Figma as part of the CW1 portfolio to support realistic navigation during usability tasks.
- Task-Based Usability Testing with Think-Aloud Observation Form: [Task based scenario Questionnaire](#) - This form was used by me to record behavioural data during interaction including:
 - Task completion success/failure
 - Time taken
 - Errors or hesitations
 - Anonymised verbalisations (direct quotes from users)
- System Usability Scale (SUS) Form: <https://forms.gle/8Kickzf1rtxoPp6X9> - is a simple 10-item Likert scale questionnaire that provides a subjective rating of a system's usability.
- Post-Use Survey Questionnaire: ['Homify' Application User Survey – Fill out form](#) - Completed after task execution, consisting of:
 - 8 emotion-focused questions aligned with Jordan's Four Pleasures Framework
 - 12-item questionnaire integrating aesthetics and UX, comprising 4 open-ended questions, 1 Likert-scale item, and 7 MCQs
- Semi-Structured Interview: [Interview questions – Fill out form](#) - A brief follow-up conversation script exploring:
 - Emotional responses to features

- Perceptions of control, trust, collaboration, and areas for improvement after first-time use.
- **Data Recording Tools** - Questionnaire responses were collected digitally via Google & Microsoft Forms on participants' laptops or smartphones, while observation notes were recorded manually.

2.4 Procedure

The evaluation was administered remotely, with each participant individually interacting with the clickable Figma prototype of Homify. A consistent procedure was followed across all 12 sessions.

Introduction & Consent (5 minutes)

Participants were informed of the study purpose i.e., to evaluate usability and emotional experience, and assured of confidentiality before providing consent.

Prototype Familiarisation (2 minutes)

A brief orientation allowed participants to navigate between screens to ensure they were comfortable with the Figma interface.

Task-Based Usability Testing with Think-Aloud (25–30 minutes)

Participants completed core shopping tasks, including browsing, viewing product details and AR preview, adding to cart, exploring shared cart, modifying payment, and locating delivery updates and review submission. Behavioural data such as task success, time, errors and verbalised thoughts were recorded.

Post-Task Survey (6-12 minutes)

A structured questionnaire captured perceptions of navigation clarity, trust, confidence, emotional engagement, and aesthetics, mapped to Norman's and Jordan's frameworks.

Semi-Structured Interview (45-60 minutes)

Short discussions explored users' reflections on trust, comfort, feature discoverability and improvement opportunities. Responses were anonymised for thematic analysis.

Debrief (2 minutes)

Participants shared final comments before closing the session.

CHAPTER – 3: STUDY RESULTS

3.1 Quantitative Results - Usability testing

A total of 10 tasks were given to 12 participants to complete. All participants are anonymized as P1 to P12 for this report. The following table consists of the measures considered for this task.

Task No.	Tasks	Success Rate	Average time taken (in seconds)	Errors/Difficulties, if any	Direct quote
1	Initial exploration	11/12	15.5	Mostly none	P5: "I'd just start scrolling to see what's available. It looks visually appealing so I want to explore more."
2	Find dining room items	11/12	20.7	Mostly none	P8: "Dining category done. I want the fastest way."
3	Use AR "See in Your Room"	7/12	36.3	Feature lacked visibility for some users	P9: "I expected something larger promoting AR, but I couldn't find it."
4	View product details	11/12	165.1	Mostly none	P1: "Tapping on the product will take me to its details page where I can find everything about the product"
5	Add to cart	11/12	20.4	Mostly none	P7: "The button blends nicely with the theme. Very aesthetic."
6	Shared shopping (collaboration)	8/12	66.3	Few users struggled to find this feature	P8: "In significant places like the cart page or checkout page."
7	Proceed to checkout	11/12	20.3	Very smooth completion overall	P9: "I will go to the checkout step"
8	Change payment method	8/12	32.7	Few users struggled to find this button	P3: "I clicked around until it worked."
9	Track delivery	12/12	21.1	No issues	P5: "Very intuitive. I knew instantly where to find delivery updates."
10	Leave a review	7/12	107.8	Review option not easily visible post-delivery	P6: "I looked at my orders and that worked fine. Just needed some time though."

Table 1: Quantitative analysis of usability testing

Interpretation:

The table shows that the primary shopping flow is largely effective and most participants completed core tasks successfully. In contrast, AR preview, shared cart and review submission were slower and less successful, indicating that these advanced features need clearer labelling and stronger visual affordances.

3.1.1 System Usability Scale Score:

All the participants completed the SUS question form and the scores were calculated the standard SUS scoring method ([Brooke, 1995](#)) where

1. Questions 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 were scored as Score – 1
2. Questions 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 were scored as 5 – Score
3. SUS score = Total score * 2.5

Each participants' score ranges between 67.5 to 100, and the average of which is 84.17

Participant Number	Q1	I think that I would like to use this system frequently	Q2	I found the system unnecessarily complex	Q3	I thought the system was easy to use	Q4	I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system	Q5	I found the various functions in this system were well integrated	Q6	I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system	Q7	I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly	Q8	I found the system very cumbersome to use	Q9	I felt very confident using this system	Q10	I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system
1	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree
2	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	2	Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	2	Disagree
3	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree
4	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	4	Agree
5	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	1	Strongly Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	2	Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree
6	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree
7	4	Agree	2	Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	2	Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree
8	5	Strongly Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree
9	4	Agree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	4	Neither Agree nor Disagree	2	Disagree
10	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	2	Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	1	Strongly Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree	3	Neither Agree nor Disagree
11	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree	4	Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	4	Agree	2	Disagree
12	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree	5	Strongly Agree	1	Strongly Disagree

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10	Participant Number	SUS Score
5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	1	100
5	1	4	2	4	1	5	2	5	2	2	87.5
5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	3	100
5	1	4	2	4	2	4	1	4	4	4	77.5
3	1	3	3	5	1	3	2	3	3	5	67.5
5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	6	100
4	2	5	2	3	2	4	2	4	2	7	75
5	2	4	1	4	2	3	2	4	2	8	77.5
4	3	4	2	4	3	5	3	4	2	9	70
4	1	5	1	3	2	3	1	3	3	10	75
4	2	4	1	4	2	4	1	4	2	11	80
5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	5	1	12	100
										Average	84.17

Figure 2: SUS Form Calculation



Figure 3: Analysis of SUS Score

With an average SUS score of 84.17, Homify falls within the “Excellent” usability range according to industry benchmarks. This indicates that users generally found the application intuitive, efficient, and pleasant to use, with only minor usability improvements needed to reach a top-tier user experience.

3.2 Survey Results

Following the usability testing phase, a structured post-use survey was administered to understand participants’ perceptions of Homify’s usability, emotional impact, feature clarity and aesthetics. 12 participants completed the survey and the results were analysed in relation to Norman’s design principles and Jordan’s Four Pleasures framework (Norman, 2013; Jordan, 2002).

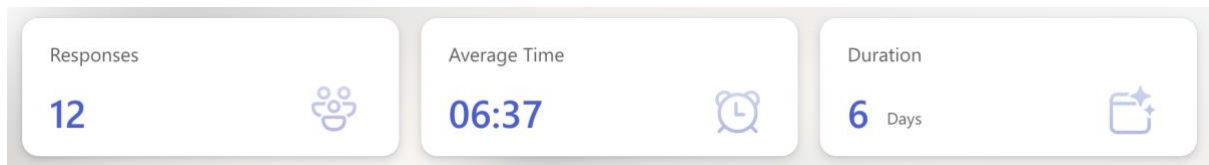


Figure 4: Survey results dashboard

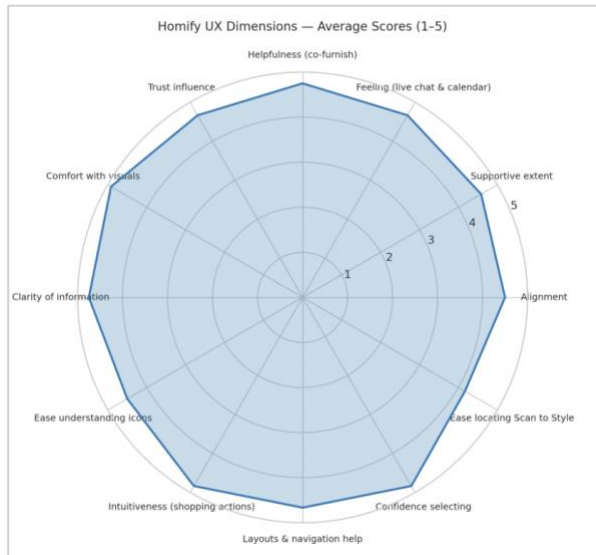


Figure 5: UX Dimension Radar chart



Figure 6: Key Usability and Trust Outcomes

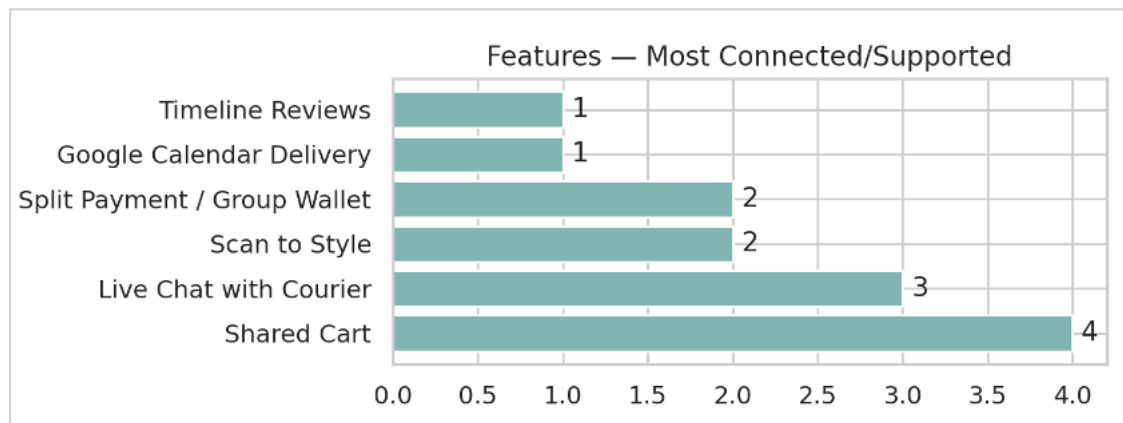


Figure 7: Most connected or supportive features for participants

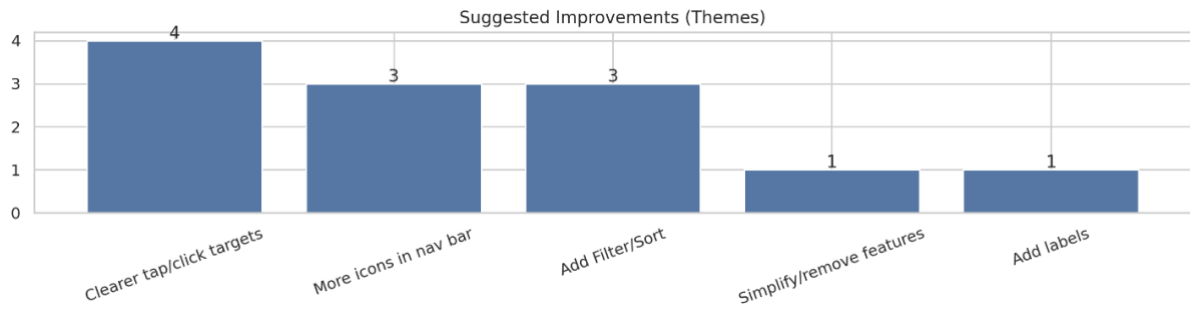


Figure 8: Suggested improvements by participants

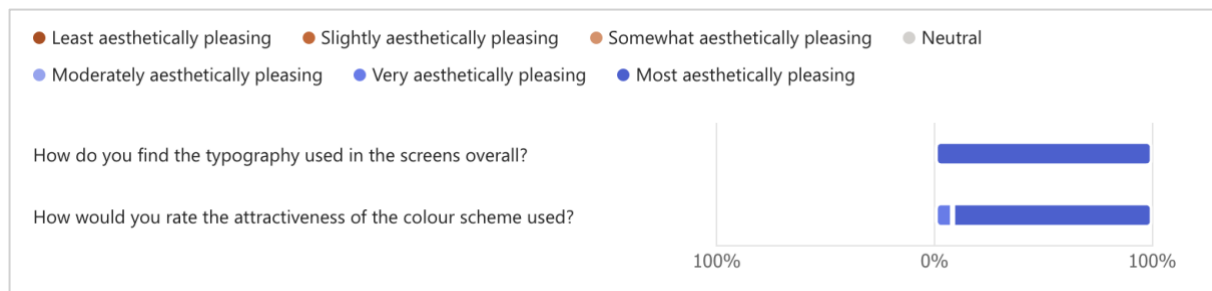


Figure 9: Aesthetics analysis of colour and typography used in the prototype

3.2.1 Strengths

Survey responses strongly indicated that Homify provides a positive and supportive user experience:

- Participants reported high visual comfort and appeal, indicating strong Physio-Pleasure and effective aesthetic accessibility
- 83% found the app highly supportive for decision-making, showing strong Visibility and Consistency while reducing cognitive effort and enhancing Psycho-Pleasure
- All participants reported increased confidence while shopping, indicating strong trust supported by consistency principle, feedback, and Ideo-Pleasure
- 83% found core tasks very intuitive, indicating strong affordance, constraints and clear mapping throughout key interactions

These findings reinforce the prototype’s capability to support users across both emotional and cognitive dimensions of the experience.

3.2.2 Positive Impact of Collaborative and Convenience Features

Advanced features including Shared Cart, Delivery Room, Split Pay / Group Wallet, and Google-synced delivery time picker were highly appreciated. Participants described them as “useful”, “practical”, and “time-saving”, particularly in scenarios involving co-living or co-shopping. This shows strong alignment with socio-pleasure and Norman’s feedback and mapping principles.

3.2.3 Areas for Improvement

While overall usability was highly rated, several features revealed discoverability limitations:

Feature / Element	Issue Reported	Interpretation	Related Frameworks
Scan-to-Style	Mixed ratings (33% struggled)	Requires more prominent signifiers	Norman: Mapping & Visibility
Staged Reviews	Felt hidden in the flow	Navigation hierarchy could be improved	Norman: Visibility & Constraints
Camera icon near search bar	Purpose not immediately understood	Signifier does not clearly communicate action	Norman: Affordance

Table 2: Areas for improvement

These findings suggest that support for exploratory behaviour can be strengthened by adjusting signifiers and navigation cues.

3.2.4 Interpretation in Relation to UX Theory

Across the survey, participants' feedback demonstrates that Homify successfully balances emotional engagement and functional clarity:

UX Theme	Norman's Principles Alignment	Jordan's Pleasures Alignment	Alignment Evaluation
Visual comfort and onboarding	Constraints, Consistency	Physio, Ideo	Excellent
Navigation & ease of action	Affordance, Mapping	Psycho	Strong, minor refinements needed
Product clarity & decision-support	Visibility, Consistency	Psycho	Excellent
Collaboration & shared experiences	Feedback, Mapping	Socio	Excellent
Trust and reliability	Feedback, Visibility	Ideo	Excellent

Table 3: UX theory interpretation theme-wise

Thus, the data indicates that Homify is emotionally resonant and cognitively supportive with only selective areas needing refinement to enhance first-time discoverability.

3.3 Qualitative Results using theme-based interviews

Qualitative responses were analysed using thematic grouping to identify common patterns across user feedback. To ensure confidentiality, participants were anonymised and labelled as P1-P12 throughout the findings.

Theme 1: Discoverability & Navigation

Users found the interface intuitive, with the Home screen guiding their attention naturally toward key product categories. Most preferred browsing over searching during initial interaction, showing that visual navigation supported early exploration effectively. Only post-purchase review submission required clearer visibility as it was not immediately discoverable.

1. When you first landed on the home screen, what guided your attention? What did you feel like tapping first, and why?

Quotes:

The big image banner and clean layout caught my attention first. I immediately wanted to explore one of the main categories because they stood out visually. It felt inviting and a good place to start shopping.

P1:

The icons at the bottom got my attention, like the cart and profile. But I started with the furniture category because that's the whole reason I'm here. The design looked modern and appealing.

P6:

My eyes first went to the navigation bar. I wanted something quick like dining room or bedroom. Honestly, I clicked what felt fastest, not necessarily what looked best.

P12:

2. Did you consider searching instead of browsing?

Quotes:

Yes, but only after scrolling a bit. Search is something I use when I already know what I want. First-time here, I preferred browsing to discover the style.

P2:

For decor, I like inspiration, so browsing made sense. Search feels too serious or specific. I wasn't ready to commit to an item name yet.

P7:

P11:

I prefer search usually, but with the categories so clear, browsing felt easier at the start.

10. Post the item delivery, what was your experience in finding where to leave a review?

Quotes:

P3:

It shouldn't hide in order history. I love sharing opinions!

P10:

Harder than I expected. Needed clearer direction.

Interpretation: It reflects Norman's visibility and mapping principles, though the staged timeline mapping could be clearer, and it elicits strong physio-pleasure.

Theme 2: Decision Support & Product Understanding

Participants reported that product details were easy to understand and well-organized, enabling quick and confident decision-making. The "See in Your Room" feature further enhanced certainty by allowing a realistic preview of items in their space, positively influencing purchase intent.

3. When viewing a product, how clear was it to understand the details before making a decision?

Quotes:

P2:

The details were structured well. Price, dimensions, and reviews were all visible. I didn't have to hunt around for info. That definitely helped me decide quickly.

P7:

I look for size and delivery info first, and they were easy to spot. So yes, it made sense.

4. What were your expectations when you saw the "See in your room" feature?

Quotes:

P6:

I wanted a realistic preview so I don't buy the wrong size. It gave me confidence before paying.

P11:

I expected to point the phone at my room and preview the furniture. That's exactly what it hinted, so I felt excited to try it.

5. How confident did you feel when adding an item to the cart? Did anything feel unexpected or confusing?

Quotes:

P4:

No issues. I just want fast actions. It did its job.

P1:

The button was very clear and the feedback was immediate. I felt secure it worked.

Interpretation: This strongly aligns with Norman's principles of consistency and feedback. Strong alignment with psycho and ideo pleasure is also seen here.

Theme 3: Collaborative & Social Features

The shared-cart feature was particularly appreciated and users felt it made purchase decisions more collaborative and enjoyable. Scan-to-Style was easier to discover compared to Staged Reviews, suggesting the latter could be made more prominent to support seamless teamwork.

6. What are your thoughts on the shared-cart collaboration feature? In what situation would you use it?

Quotes:

P3:

That's my favourite feature because I always send pictures to friends anyway. Here, we can decide together.

P10:

I didn't understand it at first. But after explanation, yes could be useful while living with family.

P9:

It's useful for roommates or couples. I'd absolutely use it while moving homes.

15. Which feature was easier for you to figure out: 'Scan to Style' or 'Staged Reviews'? Why?

Quotes:

P2:

Scan to Style as it was more visual and intuitive. Staged reviews felt a bit hidden in the overall flow.

P8:

I didn't understand staged reviews until explained. Scan to Style was obvious.

Interpretation: Shared cart offered clear socio-pleasure, with only a minor mapping issue around staged reviews that slightly reduced discoverability.

Theme 4: Trust, Security & Transparency

Delivery tracking, onboarding and Google synced delivery scheduling were viewed as reliable, which helped build trust by keeping users informed and confident. Smart recommendations further reassured users by aligning choices with their needs.

9. How helpful was the delivery tracking information to you? Did it feel reassuring or lacking in any way?

Quotes:

P4:

It was good. Straight to the point.

P9:

Delivery updates were very clear and reassuring.

12. What was your experience when viewing the 'Scan to Style' recommendations? Was it relevant or irrelevant for you to follow?

Quotes:

P12:

I liked relevant suggestions but wanted a skip option visible.

P8:

I followed it because I trust suggestions more than picking randomly.

P5:

Still new to me but the suggestions made sense. I felt guided.

13. What is your opinion about the login / onboarding screen? Did anything feel unnecessary or did it set the right expectations?

Quotes:

P5:

It was simple, no confusing steps. Set expectations well.

P7:

It helped me understand what the app does before entering.

14. Among the advanced features (Scan to Style, Shared Cart, Google Synced Delivery, Split Pay / Group Wallet, Delivery Room, Staged Reviews), which one appealed to you the most and why?

Quotes:

P1:

Scan to style feature as it adds fun and confidence. Makes buying expensive things easier.

P3:

Split payment as it is useful for families budgeting together.

P8:

Google synced delivery time selection, it's practical and smart.

Interpretation: This supports Norman's principles of visibility, feedback and constraints. Also, it aligns well with ideo pleasure from Jordan's 4 pleasures.

Theme 5: Purchase Flow Confidence

During checkout, users felt well-guided and in control, with pricing and process steps clearly communicated. Although a few hesitated when locating payment changes, the confirmation screen effectively reinforced completion and user satisfaction.

7. When going through the checkout flow, did you feel in control of the process? Were you aware of each next step?

Quotes:

P5: I like when apps keep me aware of pricing changes. This did well.

P8: I always knew what stage I was in and what I had to do next.

8. If you wanted to change the payment method, how easy or difficult would that be? Can you recall any uncertainty during that action?

Quotes:

P6: It wasn't the most obvious thing. I expected a dropdown icon or something stronger.

P7: It was easy enough. I spotted the option quickly.

11. How did you feel when you reached the order confirmation screen? What about that screen made you feel reassured or unsure?

Quotes:

P3: It gave me a sense of achievement. Nice design equals trust.

P10: The 'Your order is on its way' message made me happy and excited.

Interpretation: Strong alignment with psycho-pleasure. Norman's principles of affordance, constraint and feedback is also seen here.

S.No	Interview Themes	Direct Quote from participants
1.	Discoverability & Navigation	P4: “My eyes first went to the navigation bar. I clicked what felt fastest, not necessarily what looked best.” P6: “I prefer search usually but with the categories so clear, browsing felt easier at the start.”
2.	Decision Support & Product Understanding	P7: “The consistency was helpful everything was where I expected. It built trust right away”
3.	Collaborative & Social Features	P1: “Scan to Style as it was more visual and intuitive. Staged reviews felt a bit hidden in the overall flow.”
4.	Trust, Security & Transparency	P7: “Delivery updates were very clear and reassuring”
5.	Purchase Flow Confidence	P11: “There was a small moment of checking where the edit option is, but overall it worked as expected.”

Table 4: Overview of direct quotes across interview themes

3.4 Study results summary

Overall, participants reported a smooth experience for common tasks and a sense of emotional ease, though the study also uncovered multiple improvement opportunities.

Strengths:

- High visual comfort and aesthetic satisfaction (Physio-Pleasure)
- Strong trust and confidence while shopping (Ideo-Pleasure + Visibility & Feedback)
- Clear product information and decision support (Consistency)
- Smooth checkout and delivery tracking, reinforcing user control (Constraints + Feedback)
- High appreciation for collaborative features (Socio-pleasure, mapping), especially:
 - Shared Cart
 - Live chat with courier in Delivery Room
 - Split Payment and add to group wallet
 - Google-synchronised delivery time picker

Weaknesses:

- “Scan to Style” was harder to find for one-third of users (Mapping & Visibility gap)
- Staged Reviews felt hidden within the navigation flow
- Camera icon affordance was unclear to some users
- Locating collaboration and payment modification options required extra effort
- Filter and sort options in product search results could have been kept for enhanced product search

These findings offer a strong basis for the reflective discussion that follows.

CHAPTER 4 - DISCUSSION

This study evaluated the usability and emotional experience of the Homify prototype through usability testing, surveys, and interviews. Findings show that the system provides an engaging and intuitive shopping experience grounded in strong interaction design principles, while also revealing opportunities to improve discoverability of advanced features.

4.1 Alignment with Norman's Design Principles

The findings strongly demonstrate the effectiveness of Visibility, Consistency, Affordance, Feedback, Mapping and Constraints across the app. Clear product details, visible action cues, and step-by-step checkout flows helped participants understand where they were and what actions were possible. This minimized cognitive load and fostered confidence throughout product exploration and purchase tasks.

However, Mapping and Affordance were less successful in areas such as tap target for Scan-to-Style and Staged Reviews section. These features lacked strong signifiers, causing hesitation or requiring additional explanation. Thus, while Norman's principles are well represented in core functionality, few improvements are required to ensure consistent intuitive interaction across the entire system.

4.2 Alignment with Jordan's Four Pleasures

The evaluation revealed that Homify successfully supports a wide range of emotional needs as outlined in Jordan's Four Pleasures framework.

- Physio-pleasure was strongly demonstrated through the highly rated visual comfort and aesthetically appealing interface which encouraged users to explore the product catalogue without hesitation.
- Psycho-pleasure was evident in the well-structured product details and intuitive task flows that enabled users to make confident decisions with minimal cognitive effort.
- Socio-pleasure was introduced through features such as Shared Cart and Group Wallet, which users described as practical and enjoyable when furnishing a home collaboratively with family members or roommates.
- Finally, Ideo-pleasure was reinforced through reliable delivery updates, clear confirmation messages and AR preview, all of which contributed to a sense of trust and brand credibility.

Together, these findings show that Homify not only fulfils functional shopping goals but also creates a positive emotional connection that enhances the overall user experience.

4.3 Strengths and Weaknesses in Context

The strengths of Homify lie in its consistency of visual and interaction design, strong support for decision-making, and trust-building features such as delivery tracking and confirmation messaging. These aspects demonstrate usability and emotional engagement early in the product lifecycle.

Conversely, weaknesses emerged in discoverability and learnability of advanced features. These aspects are less frequented by users during typical shopping behaviour; therefore, they require clearer visual anchors or guided prompts. Addressing these will ensure a more seamless experience especially for first-time or non-tech-savvy shoppers.

4.4 Implications for Future Design

To further improve the user experience, the following refinements are recommended based on the study findings:

- **Enhance Feature Discoverability**
Make Scan-to-Style, Staged Reviews, and collaboration options more visually prominent and easier to locate.
- **Improve Navigation Mapping and Hierarchy**
Re-organise information flow so users can more intuitively progress between browsing, collaboration, and review steps.
- **Clarify Icon Affordances**
Redesign icons such as the camera symbol to better communicate their intended functionality.
- **Support Contextual Guidance**
Provide micro-hints or onboarding prompts that surface advanced features when users are likely to need them.

These enhancements will strengthen alignment with Norman's principles and Jordan's Four Pleasures, improving usability and long-term adoption.

CHAPTER 5 - CONCLUSION

Overall, the results from usability testing, SUS scores, surveys, and interviews demonstrate that Homify's 10-screen shopping flow delivers strong usability and a positive emotional experience suitable for a modern furniture-shopping application. Core shopping tasks were completed efficiently and confidently, reflecting effective visibility, mapping, consistency, feedback, constraints, and affordances in line with Norman's interaction design principles ([Norman, 2013](#)). Simultaneously, users expressed comfort, trust, and personal connection with the interface, showing alignment with Jordan's Four Pleasures ([Jordan, 2002](#)) and confirming that the design supports both functional and emotional engagement.

The findings also highlight strengths in cognitive support and collaboration, as participants valued clear product information and the shared-cart feature for decision-making with others. However, discoverability issues were consistently noted for advanced features such as Scan-to-Style and Staged Reviews, indicating the need for clearer signifiers and improved navigation hierarchy. These are targeted refinements rather than fundamental redesign concerns.

In summary, the study validates Homify's design direction while identifying practical improvements that can further enhance learnability and the emotional quality of the experience. Strengthening visual cues and contextual guidance will allow future iterations to deepen usability and satisfaction across the full shopping journey. This positions Homify as a strong user-centred solution in the online home-furnishing space, demonstrating clear value in applying UX and emotional design principles.

CHAPTER 6 – REFERENCES

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CHAPTER 7 – APPENDIX

Usability testing Tasks: [Task based scenario Questionnaire](#)

SUS Form: <https://forms.gle/8KickzflrtxoPp6X9>

SUS Score Calculation: [SUS Form Calculation.xlsx](#)

Survey Form: ['Homify' Application User Survey – Fill out form](#)

Survey Results: ['Homify' Application User Survey\(1-12\).xlsx](#)

Interviews: [Interview questions – Fill out form](#)

Usability testing Tasks Questionnaire:

1. Imagine you just opened this app, what would you do first on this screen?
2. Imagine you want to find furniture that suits your dining room. Where would you go from here?
3. Imagine you want to view how a product looks at home. What would you do next?
4. Imagine you want to read more details about a product before deciding. What would you tap?
5. Imagine you want to add this product to your cart, how would you do that?
6. Imagine you want to involve someone you live with in shopping decisions. Where would you look in the app to do that?
7. Imagine you are ready to purchase, what would you do from this point?
8. Imagine you prefer paying in a different way, how would you change your payment method?
9. Imagine you've been notified that your product is out of delivery and will reach you today. What would you do now?
10. Imagine the item has been delivered, and you want to leave a review. How would you do that here?

SUS Form Points: Likert-scale based response where 1- Strongly disagree, 2 - Disagree, 3- Neutral, 4 - Agree, and 5 - Strongly agree

1. I think that I would like to use this system frequently
2. I found the system unnecessarily complex
3. I thought the system was easy to use
4. I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system
5. I found the various functions in this system were well integrated
6. I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system
7. I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly
8. I found the system very cumbersome to use
9. I felt very confident using the system
10. I needed to learn a lot of things before I could get going with this system

Survey Questions:

1. Select your profession
 - Student
 - Arts field
 - IT field
 - Architecture field
 - Retired
2. How would you describe the experience of interacting with the 'shared cart' or 'delivery room' features? Let me know your experience in words here
(open ended response)
3. How would you describe the app's alignment with your personal approach to home organization or decor style?
 - Perfectly aligned
 - Very aligned
 - Moderately aligned
 - Slightly aligned
 - Not at all aligned
 - Other
4. To what extent do you feel the app could support confident decision-making while shopping for home products?
 - Completely supportive
 - Very supportive
 - Moderately supportive
 - Not supportive
 - Not supportive at all
 - Other
5. How did features like live chat implementation and google calendar synchronized delivery time suggestions make you feel about the application?
 - Very positive
 - Positive
 - Neutral
 - Negative
 - Very negative
 - Prefer not to say
 - Other
6. How helpful would this app be if you needed to furnish a living space with someone else?
 - Very helpful
 - Somewhat helpful
 - Neither helpful nor unhelpful
 - Somewhat unhelpful
 - Very unhelpful
 - Other
7. Which feature made you feel the most connected or supported? Why?
(open ended response)

8. How did the app's visual style or layout influence your trust while shopping?

- Strongly increased my trust
- Slightly increased my trust
- No influence on my trust
- Slightly decreased my trust
- Strongly decreased my trust
- Prefer not to say
- Other

9. Were there any elements on the screen whose purpose you needed to think about before using them? If yes, please describe
(open ended response)

10. How would you describe your overall comfort interacting with the visual elements (e.g., colors, spacing, font sizes)?

- Very comfortable
- Somewhat comfortable
- Neither comfortable nor uncomfortable
- Somewhat uncomfortable
- Very uncomfortable
- Other

11. How would you describe the clarity of information shown on each screen while completing tasks?

- Very good
- Good
- Fair
- Poor
- Very poor
- Other

12. How easy or difficult was it to understand what each button or icon would do before clicking it?

- Extremely easy
- Somewhat easy
- Neutral
- Somewhat difficult
- Extremely difficult
- Other

13. How intuitive was it to carry out actions related to shopping (e.g., searching, adding to cart, paying for items)?

- Very intuitive
- Somewhat intuitive
- Neutral
- Somewhat not intuitive
- Not intuitive at all
- Other

14. How do the layouts and navigation structure help you understand where you are in the shopping process?

- Extremely well
- Very well
- Somewhat well
- Neutral
- Somewhat not well
- Not so well
- Extremely not well
- Other

15. If you were to improve one part of the visual or interaction experience, what would it be and why?

(open ended response)

16. Was there any moment when you felt unsure about what the app would do next? If yes, please explain.

(open ended response)

17. Based on the high fidelity prototype of Homify, how do you rate the following?

a. How do you find the typography used in the screens overall?

b. How would you rate the attractiveness of the colour scheme used?

- Least aesthetically pleasing
- Slightly aesthetically pleasing
- Somewhat aesthetically pleasing
- Neutral
- Moderately aesthetically pleasing
- Very aesthetically pleasing
- Most aesthetically pleasing

18. Was there any point during your interaction where you noticed the physical effort required to use the app? If yes, please describe.

(open ended response)

19. If you could improve one thing to make exploring products easier, what would it be?

(open ended response)

20. How confident did you feel that you selected the correct option when interacting with icons or menu items?

- Extremely confident
- Somewhat confident
- Neutral
- Somewhat not confident
- Extremely not confident
- Other

21. How easy or difficult was it for you to locate the “Scan to Style” feature?

- Extremely easy
- Somewhat easy
- Neutral

- Somewhat not easy
- Extremely not easy

Interview Questions:

1. When you first landed on the home screen, what guided your attention? What did you feel like tapping first, and why?
2. Did you consider searching instead of browsing?
3. When viewing a product, how clear was it to understand the details before making a decision?
4. What were your expectations when you saw the “See in your room” feature?
5. How confident did you feel when adding an item to the cart? Did anything feel unexpected or confusing?
6. What are your thoughts on the shared-cart collaboration feature? In what situation would you use it?
7. When going through the checkout flow, did you feel in control of the process? Were you aware of each next step?
8. If you wanted to change the payment method, how easy or difficult would that be? Can you recall any uncertainty during that action?
9. How helpful was the delivery tracking information to you? Did it feel reassuring or lacking in any way?
10. Post the item delivery, what was your experience in finding where to leave a review?
11. How did you feel when you reached the order confirmation screen? What about that screen made you feel reassured or unsure?
12. What was your experience when viewing the ‘Scan to Style’ recommendations? Was it relevant or irrelevant for you to follow?
13. What is your opinion about the login / onboarding screen? Did anything feel unnecessary or did it set the right expectations?
14. Among the advanced features (Scan to Style, Shared Cart, Google Synced Delivery, Split Pay / Group Wallet, Delivery Room, Staged Reviews), which one appealed to you the most and why?
15. Which feature was easier for you to figure out: ‘Scan to Style’ or ‘Staged Reviews’? Why?